

Fauna Core Rules

Fauna are a special Unit type in Dropzone Commander, that represent the native alien animals of a planet. Some of these were once kept at bay by civilisation, but with the devastation caused by the Scourge many of these massive creatures have claimed mankind's ruined cities as their own territory. Others appear to be genetically engineered bioforms, left in place as indigenous guardians of ancient Bioficer structures.

These Units are for use in various scenarios; either Fauna-specific missions built around them or added to existing scenarios to change things up. They cannot typically be taken as part of an army, and instead form a third force in games that attack anything that comes too close. A clever commander can weaponise this, driving the megafauna toward the enemy, while a reckless one might discover that several tons of chitin-clad muscle are easily as deadly as any tank.

1. The Basics

Fauna are either Vehicles, Aircraft or Infantry Units, with the following exceptions and additions to the normal rules for these Units:

- Fauna cannot be taken as part of an army, but have a nominal points value for their KP and for contesting Objectives.
- Destroyed Fauna do not count for KP for either player unless stated by the Scenario. When they do count for KP, KP are only awarded for Fauna destroyed by a player's Attacks, Command Cards, Collateral Damage or Zone destruction resulting from those attacks. Fauna destroyed in CQB with both players having Occupiers in the Zone have their KP divided equally between players.
- Fauna do otherwise count as enemy Units for objectives - e.g. Fauna Vehicles will affect whether a player scores Secure, Fauna Infantry Contest Zones (and so affect Occupy), and so on.
- Each Fauna Group is a single Squad of Fauna. The Squad size is agreed by both players when setting up the Scenario, unless stated by the Scenario itself.
- Fauna are a subtype of unit e.g. Vehicle (Fauna) Aircraft (Fauna) and Infantry (Fauna).
- Fauna are always considered by both players to be enemy Units.
- Fauna treat all Fauna with the same name as friendly units, and treat all Units with different names as enemy Units.
- Fauna cannot be targeted by Command Cards.
- Fauna movement is not affected by Exceptional or Poor ground.
- All Fauna Vehicles and Aircraft have the UC rule.

2. Activating Fauna

2.1 Activation Dice

At the start of the round, roll 1d3+3 (the Fauna's Activation Dice) for each Fauna Group and place it next to the Fauna. Reduce the dice value by 1 at the end of every Normal Activation from either player.

When the dice reaches zero, that Fauna Group activates.

At the end of the Fauna Group's Activation, roll another Activation Dice. The Fauna will activate again after that many Normal Activations. This does mean that Fauna can activate multiple times per round, and Activation Dice persist across rounds.

If multiple Fauna Groups would activate simultaneously, randomly determine an activation order and resolve each Fauna Group one at a time.

After a Fauna's activation, Normal Activations resume until a Fauna activates again (e.g Player A takes an activation, a Fauna Group's dice reaches zero and it activates, then Player B takes an activation).

2.2 Fauna Activation and Movement

When a Fauna Group activates, the Squad performs the following steps:

1. Select Prey (see below).
2. Move toward Prey. Each Unit in the Squad moves up to its movement, taking the shortest path and ending as close as possible to and directly facing the Prey.
3. Attack Prey. Each Unit targets and attacks the Prey with all its weapons that are in range.

If a Fauna unit moves in any other manner (such as when it moves according to its Instinct), it ends its movement facing in the direction of travel.

2.3 Fauna Attacks

When a Fauna attacks, all weapons in the Squad target and attack the Prey Unit if in range, arc and line of sight, with the following exceptions:

- AA weapons instead target the nearest enemy Aircraft in range, arc and Line of Sight. If none are in range they will target the Prey.
- Flame and Seeker weapons instead target the nearest enemy Infantry Unit or Squad in range, arc and line of sight, treating Infantry Occupying Zones as being in Line of Sight if the Zone itself is in Line of Sight. If none are in range they will target the Prey.
- Small Arms weapons instead target the nearest enemy Infantry Unit or Squad in range, arc and Line of Sight. If none are in range they will target the Prey.
- If Occupying Infantry are selected as Prey, all weapons without Flame or Seeker and all Small Arms Weapons will instead target the Zone that the Infantry Occupy. If the Zone is not in range or arc or the Weapon cannot damage it, they instead target the nearest enemy Unit in range, arc and Line of Sight.
- Field Weapons do not target anything and are instead attacked with whenever the Fauna attacks, provided at least one enemy Unit is within range.

3. Prey Selection

Fauna select Prey in the following order - read from top to bottom, selecting the first applicable Unit as Prey:

1. An enemy unit in CC Range.
2. The closest enemy unit in Line of Sight, in Charge Range.
3. The closest enemy unit in Line of Sight, in Threat Range.
4. The closest enemy unit not in Line of Sight, in Charge Range.
5. The closest enemy unit not in Line of Sight, in Threat Range.
6. No Prey is selected.

If multiple units (or for infantry in Zones, multiple squads) would be selected as Prey, randomise.

3.1 CC, Charge and Threat Range

Prey Selection uses three terms for determining targets:

- **CC Range.** Any part of the attacking miniature or its base/flight stand is touching any part of the target miniature or its base/flight stand.
- **Charge Range.** Within range for one or more Units in the Squad to move into CC range of the target miniature.
- **Threat Range.** Within range for one or more Units in the Squad to move into range with one or more of its weapons of the target miniature, but not into CC range.

3.2 No Prey

If a Fauna Squad activates and selects no Prey, it does not Move and Attack and instead acts according to its Instinct (see below).

3.3 Invulnerable Prey

Fauna will not pick a unit as Prey if none of their weapons are capable of damaging it. Penetrative and Destroyer weapons are always capable of damaging targets.

3.4 Preferred Prey

Some unit or mission special rules will override normal Fauna targeting with Preferred Prey (e.g Aircraft).

If a Fauna Squad has a Preferred Prey, go through Prey Selection steps 1-5 with only that type of Unit being selectable. If no Prey would be selected as a result, follow normal Prey Selection.

E.g., a Feral Vampire has Aircraft as its Preferred Prey, so it will check Prey Selection steps 1-5 for Aircraft Prey first, only checking for non-Aircraft Prey if it can't find an Aircraft in range.

3.5 Preying on Aircraft

Aircraft can only be selected as Prey if the Fauna have one or more AA weapons.

3.5 Preying on Infantry

Infantry Occupying Zones can only be selected as Prey if the Fauna have one or more Flame or Seeker weapons, or if those Infantry are Sited. If the Infantry are Sited, use the face of the Building or the Point on the edge of the Area they are Sited at for determining if they are the closest target and/or in Line of Sight.

4. Zones

4.1 Nests

Some scenarios may designate specific Zones as Nests for specific Fauna. If a Nest is not specified and one or more Fauna Squads have Instinct: Defend, they must be deployed within 3" of a Zone within 6" of the centre line of the table. That Zone becomes that Squad's Nest. Multiple Fauna Squads of the same name can share a Nest, but otherwise must be assigned different Nests.

If a Nest is destroyed, all Fauna associated with that Nest change their Instinct to Instinct: Flee for the rest of the game.

4.2 X Hive

Hives are an Effect Feature that can be attached to a Zone as normal, normally by the scenario in which they appear. X denotes the Fauna Unit, e.g Feral Vampire Hive.

At the start of the End Phase, players alternate activating Hives, starting with the player with the initiative. When a Hive is activated it spawns a maximum sized Squad of Fauna X.

Spawned Infestation Fauna are placed in the Zone the Feature is attached to. Any other spawned Fauna are placed in physical contact with the Zone by the player activating the Hive. They then roll their Activation Dice as normal.

The total number of X Squads that can be on the table is the number of intact Hives of that type on the table. If there are as many Squads of that Fauna already on the table as there Hives, no more Hives of that type may be activated that round.

5. Scenarios

Fauna Scenarios can be found in the separate Fauna Scenarios pack, available on the Dropzone Commander Resources page of the TTCombat Website.

In addition, Fauna can be added to any scenario with both players' agreement. Fauna are not designed for competitive play, but players are encouraged to add them to scenarios for variety and flavour. A good rule of thumb is no more than one Fauna Group per full 500pts of game size - e.g., a 1,750pt game could have three groups of Fauna.

5.1 Entry

At the start of the game, immediately before the first initiation phase, players roll off and alternate deploying Fauna Squads. All Fauna start the game with Obscured tokens, even Fauna that otherwise would be unable to be Obscured.

Deployed

Unless stated otherwise, Fauna must begin on the Table within 6" of the centre line, at least 6" away from all other Fauna and Deployed Units.

Infesting

Fauna with the Infantry type instead begin in an eligible Zone. Any Zones that contain Objects, are an Occupy or Secure Objective, or are within 6" of the centre line of the Table are eligible Zones.

Underground

Fauna with Burrowing begin the game underground, in Holding.

5.2 Defending Nests

Fauna with Instinct: Defend must begin within 3" of their Nest, still within 6" of the centre line of the Table.

6. Weapon Rule Adjustments

6.1.1 Focus

Fauna will always use the Focus rule to combine all hits into one. When determining if the Fauna can damage a unit, assume all shots from the Focus weapon hit. E.g., a weapon with Att 3, E3 and Focus 2 would be treated as E7 for determining if targets are invulnerable.

6.1.2 Battery

The closest Unit in the attacking Fauna Squad is always the Unit making the attack.

6.1.3 Small Arms Weapons

Fauna will always combine attacks from Small Arms Weapons if able to. They combine all Small Arms weapons in the Squad into the same target unit. Use the combined attack energy value for determining if targets are invulnerable.

7. Unit Special Rules

7.1.1 Aggressive

At the end of a Normal Activation in which this Squad suffered 1 or more damage, reduce its Activation dice value by 2 instead of 1.

7.1.2 Burrowing

When this Squad is Deployed, it is instead placed off the board, and starts the game in Holding. It does not activate in the first round of the game. At the start of the second round, both players roll off. The winner places a Burrowing token anywhere on Ground other than Impassable Ground and then rolls the Group's Activation Dice.

When the Activation dice reaches zero, the Fauna squad is placed with all Units as close as possible to the token. The Fauna then activate immediately and roll Activation Dice as normal for the rest of the game.

If the Fauna cannot be placed, both players roll off and place a new marker, rolling a new Activation dice.

7.1.3 Docile

This Fauna starts the game Docile. Deploy it as normal but do not roll an activation dice for it.

A Docile Fauna does not Activate until an enemy Unit ends its activation within 6" of it, or until it is takes damage in an Activation. When either of these occur the Fauna changes from Docile to Enraged, and activates immediately after the current Activation.

If an Enraged Fauna selects Prey, roll an Activation Dice as normal at the end of its Activation. If it is unable to select Prey, do not roll an Activation Dice - it reverts to Docile.

7.1.4 Frenzied

When this Fauna ends its activation, if all units in the Squad have half or fewer of their initial DP remaining, it activates again in 1d3 activations instead of 1d3+3.

Frenzied Infantry Fauna do not have their OF reduced to half by being Sited, Concussed or reduced to half or fewer DP.

7.1.5 Infestation

Fauna with Infestation are always Infantry and cannot leave the Zone that they start the game Occupying. They start the game Controlling that Zone.

Do not roll an activation dice for this Fauna Group. Instead, it automatically activates at the end of the Activation Phase of each round (if multiple Fauna Groups have Infestation, randomise the order). They do not move or attack in their Activation, but will cause a CQB to begin if any enemy Infantry are in the same Zone and a CQB has not already happened this round.

The Fauna complete step 1 of the CQB at the same time as any players, then complete steps 2-5 after all players. They distribute their hits as evenly as possible across all enemy Squads in the CQB, with any remainder assigned to a single enemy Squad by the player with Initiative.

If the Fauna fail a Bravery test in step 7, they are destroyed. If the Fauna Occupy a Building when it is destroyed, they are placed in the ensuing Area if they survive. If the Fauna Occupy an Area when it is destroyed, they are destroyed.

7.1.6 Instinct: X

When a Fauna is unable to select a Prey, it instead follows its Instinct.

- **Skulk:** The Squad moves to be out of line of sight of as many other Units as possible, ending its move when it is no longer visible to the maximum number of other Units. If it cannot move out of line of sight of at least one other unit, it moves 0". At the end of its Activation, the Squad gains an Obscured status token, and it rolls 1d3+3 for its activation dice.
- **Defend:** The Squad moves as close as possible toward its Nest (see above). Roll 1d3+3 for its Activation dice.
- **Flee:** The Squad moves to be as far away as possible from all other Units in Line of Sight. Roll 1d3+3 for its Activation dice.
- **Hunt:** Resolve Prey Selection again, treating all enemy Units as being within Threat Range, then move toward that Prey. Roll 1d3+3 for its Activation dice.
- **Tunnel:** Place a Burrowing token for this Squad directly underneath the nearest non-aircraft enemy Unit. The Fauna is then removed from the board and placed in Holding. Roll 1d3+3 for its Activation dice. When the Fauna activates, it arrives via Burrowing.

7.1.7 Intelligent

You may take up to one Fauna Group with this rule as a part of your army in casual games. It does not count toward your total number of Groups for army composition or pass token generation. It is still considered an enemy Unit by you, but it treats all Units outside its own Squad as enemy Units, even other Fauna of the same name.

The Fauna is always deployed by you rather than by roll-off, otherwise following the deployment rules for Fauna. It awards KP to your opponent when destroyed, but does not count as a friendly unit for any Objectives.

When the Fauna selects Prey, treat all of your units as being double the distance from the Fauna that they actually are. E.g., your own unit that is 3" from the Fauna would be treated as being 6" away. Units in Melee Range are still in Melee Range.

If this Unit is not taken as part of a player's army, this rule has no effect.

7.1.8 Preferred Prey: X

When resolving Prey Selection, the Fauna Squad will prioritise X if possible (see 3.4 Preferred Prey).

7.1.9 Territorial

Enemy Units with Large or with more initial DP than this Unit's initial DP are Preferred Prey.

7.1.10 Voracious

Enemy Infantry outside Zones, Units with 1DP and Units with half or fewer of their initial DP are Preferred Prey.

When this Squad ends its activation, if it destroyed at least one enemy Unit this activation and there are no other Squads within 6", it activates next in 1d3+6 activations instead of 1d3+3.

8. Weapon Special Rules

8.1.1 Eruption

This uses the same rules as a Field weapon, except that the Unit automatically attacks with this Weapon immediately after entering the board from Holding. The unit otherwise cannot attack with the weapon.

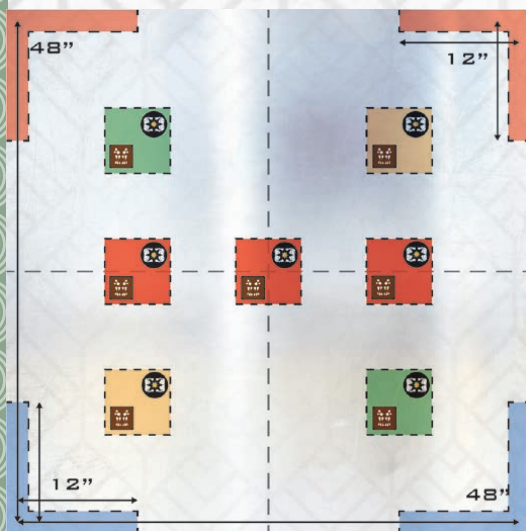
8.1.2 Death Throes

When the Unit with this Weapon is destroyed, it automatically attacks with this Weapon before being removed from the board.

8.1.3 Grapple

If a Vehicle without Large is hit by this weapon, it is Grappled. The Unit with the Weapon is Grappling it. A Unit stops Grappling when it is destroyed, suffers damage, moves out of physical contact or attacks a different Unit with the Grapple weapon. A Unit being Grappled by one or more Units has a Mv of N/A and cannot Embark.

Pest Control



-  **3 Medium Zones**
Each contains 1 Object.
-  **2 Medium Zones**
Each contains 1 Object
Only use in Clash, Battle & Reconquest
-  **2 Medium Zones**
Each contains 1 Object
Only use in Battle & Reconquest
-  **X Hive.** Each Hive starts the game with X not defined.
-  **Extract** these Objects from Friendly Lines for 2/1 VP.

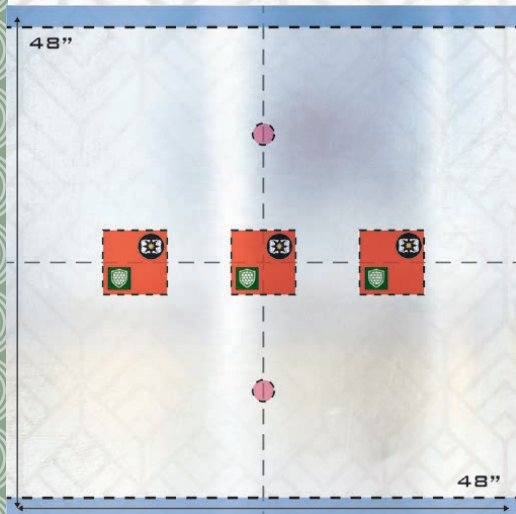
Attrition for 1VP. Destroyed Fauna count for this Objective.

Entry: Ready or Reserved

The first time a Hive Activates or the first time an Infantry Squad enters the Zone containing the Hive, roll 1d6. On a 1-2, remove the Hive. On a 3-4, it becomes a Feral Vampires Hive for the rest of the game. On a 5-6, it becomes a Daggers Hive for the rest of the game.

Variant: Remove all Hives other than those in the Red Zones. Those Hives become Mauler Hives. At the start of the game, deploy three squads of Maulers. Each Red Zone is a Mauler Nest

Death From Below



3 medium Zones

Each contains 1 Object



Shield Generator. These only function with Occupiers present.



1 Gorgon Queen in Holding.



Extract these Objects from Friendly Lines for 3/1 VP.



Secure these Points for 2/1 VP. Score on Round 4 and game end.

Entry: Ready or Reserved.

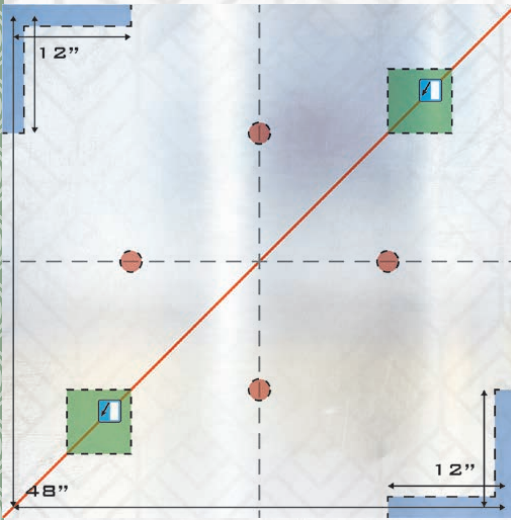
When the Gorgon Queen is destroyed, leave its model in place. It becomes an Area with A4 and 10DP. It contains an Object that is worth the same VP for Extract as the other Objects.

While any Shield Generators are functioning, the Gorgon Queen's Burrowing Token can only be placed within 6" of a Zone with a functioning Shield Generator. If there are no Shield Generators functioning, it can be placed as normal.

Variant 1: Remove the Secure points. Add two more Gorgon Queens.

Variant 2: Every time a Squad disembarks from a transport within 18" of a Burrowing Token, move that Token 1d6+3" directly toward the Squad and reduce the Gorgon Queen's Activation Dice by 1.

Hunting Grounds



2 Large Zones



Excellent Vantage



1 full strength Fauna Squad, and +1 full strength Fauna Squad per full 500pts of game size.



Centre line of Table.



Occupy these **Zones** for 3/1 VP. Score on Round 4 and game end.



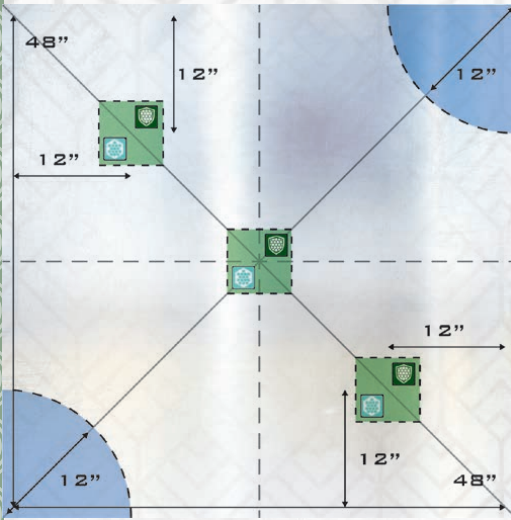
Secure these **Points** for 2/1 VP. Score on Round 4 and game end.

Entry: Ready or Reserved.

Units within 6" of a Secure Point are considered to be half the distance from all Fauna that they actually are when that Fauna Squad is Selecting Prey.

Variant: Remove Occupy. Add Attrition, with all Fauna counting as double their points for KP.

Slumbering Giants



3 Medium Hardened Areas



ACM Package



Shield Generator



1 Typhon



Secure these Zones for 3/1 VP. Score on Round 2, 4, and game end.



Explore these Zones for 1 VP.

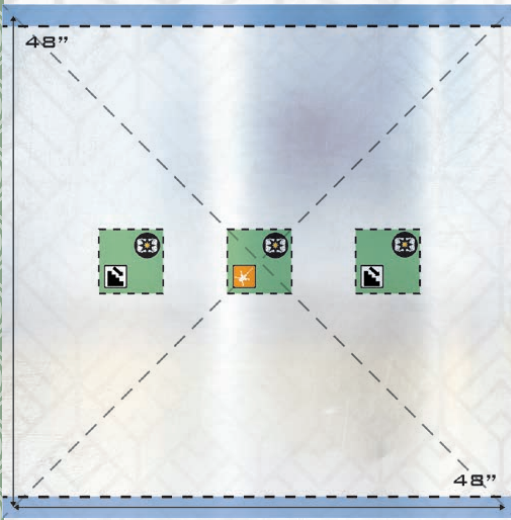
Dominate each table half (measured diagonally top left to bottom right) for 3/1 VP. Score on round 2, 4, and game end

Entry: Ready or Reserved.

The Typhon treats all of the green Areas as its Nest. While it is 6" or more from all green Areas it has Aggressive and Frenzied.

Variant: Add a second Typhon. Both always treat the other Typhon as an Enemy Unit and Preferred Prey.

Stranded



3 Medium Zones

Each contains 1 Object



Flak Turret



Basement



1 Keres per full 500pts of game size

Attrition (attacker only) for 1 VP



Extract (defender only) for 2/0 VP

Entry: Ready or Reserved.

Variant 1: Remove the Objects from the Zones. Instead, each Keres starts the game carrying an Object. They only drop the Objects when destroyed.

Variant 2: Replace each Keres with any other non-Infantry Fauna Squad without Burrowing.

This Scenario has an Attacker and a Defender. The Defender may Deploy up to two Infantry Squads in each marked Zone. Those Squads' Transports, any Transports capable of transporting Infantry and any Transports carrying Units capable of transporting Infantry start Reserved.

Neither player may Deploy Units via Infiltrate. Bioficer armies are never the Defender for this Scenario.

For the purpose of Instinct: Skulk, the Keres treat the Zone with the Flak Turret as an enemy Unit with Line of Sight from every point along its edges while that Zone contains any Infantry.



Type	Mv	A	DP	Special				
Vehicle (Fauna)	4"	4	7	Intelligent, Voracious, Instinct: Hunt				
Name		Arc	MA	R	Att	Ac	E	Special
	Serrated Fangs	F	Full	CC	6	2+	5	Pen 6+
	Acid Breath	F	Full	6"	5	3+	s3	Flame



Type	Mv	A	DP	Special				
Vehicle (Fauna)	4"	7	4	Intelligent, Voracious, Instinct: Hunt				
Name		Arc	MA	R	Att	Ac	E	Special
	Serrated Fangs	F	Full	CC	3	2+	8	Pen 6+
	Acid Breath	F	Full	6"	5	3+	s3	Flame



Type	Mv	A	DP	Special
Vehicle (Fauna)	6"	4	4	Ev2, Intelligent, Voracious, Regenerate 1, Instinct: Hunt

Name	Arc	MA	R	Att	Ac	E	Special
 Serrated Fangs	F	Full	CC	3	2+	5	Pen 6+
 Acid Breath	F	Full	6"	5	3+	s3	Flame



Type	Mv	A	DP	Special				
Vehicle (Fauna)	4"	3	10	Docile, Frenzied, Resilient, Instinct: Flee				
Name		Arc	MA	R	Att	Ac	E	Special
	Thick Skull	F	Full	CC	2	4+	7	Concussion, Suppress, Dev 2



Type	Mv	OF	DF	B	DP	Special
Infantry (Fauna)	-	6	4+	4+	3	Agile 2, Frenzied, Living Weapons, Terror, Infestation

Fauna
Squad Size: 2

Feral Razorworms

20pts



Type	Mv	DF	DF	B	DP	Special
Infantry (Fauna)	-	6	4+	2+	3	Agile 1, Lethal, Living Weapons, Infestation



Type	Mv	A	DP	Special				
Aircraft (20mm Fauna)	8"	0	1	Ev2, Preferred Prey: Aircraft, Voracious, Instinct: Skulk				
Name	Arc	MA	R	Att	Ac	E	Special	
 Fangs and Claws	F	Full	CC	1	3+	2	AA-S, Focus 2, Pen 6+	



Type	Mv	A	DP	Special				
Vehicle (Fauna)	4"	6	8	Aggressive, Burrowing, Large, Instinct: Tunnel				
Name	Arc	MA	R	Att	Ac	E	Special	
 Gargantuan Jaw	F/S/R	Full	CC	1	2+	8	Dev 1d3, Destroyer 4+, Death Throes	
 Rending Claws	F/S/R	Full	CC	8	4+	4	Focus 1	
 Electromagnetic Discharge	F/SR	Full	6"	1	A	0	Eruption, Suppress, Jammer	



Type	Mv	A	DP	Special				
Aircraft (20mm Fauna)	8"	0	1	Ev1, Preferred Prey: Aircraft, Instinct: Defend				
Name		Arc	MA	R	Att	Ac	E	Special
	Hooked Claws	F	Full	CC	4	3+	S1	AA-S, Focus 1, Suppress
	Toxic Vomit	F	Full	3"	3	3+	S3	Flame



Type	Mv	A	DP	Special				
Vehicle (Fauna)	4"	6	2	Territorial, Instinct: Defend				
Name	Arc	MA	R	Att	Ac	E	Special	
 Claws and Teeth	F	Full	CC	2	3+	4	Focus 1	
 Corrosive Bile	F/S	Full	4"	5	3+	S3	Ignores Cover	



Type	Mv	A	DP	Special				
Vehicle (Fauna)	4"	5	6	Frenzied, Resilient, Large, Instinct: Defend				
Name		Arc	MA	R	Att	Ac	E	Special
	Huge Jaw	F	Full	CC	3	4+	7	Dev 2, Pen 6+
	Colossal Claws	F	Full	CC	2	3+	4	Concussion
	Barbed Spines	F/S/R	Full	8"	3	3+	2	AA-S



Type	Mv	A	DP	Special				
Vehicle (Fauna)	6"	4	2	Burrowing, Voracious, Instinct: Hunt				
Name		Arc	MA	R	Att	Ac	E	Special
	Snapping Jaw	F	Full	CC	1	3+	6	



Type	Mv	A	DP	Special
Vehicle (Fauna)	3"	7	8	Large, Resilient, Territorial, Instinct: Defend

	Name	Arc	MA	R	Att	Ac	E	Special
	Colossal Claws	F/S/R	Full	CC	2	3+	5	Demo 1, Dev 1, Focus 3
	Flailing Tail	F/S/R	Full	3"	1d3	4+	7	Concussion, Field, Demo 3, Dev 1, Death Throes
	Crushing Bite	F/SR	Full	CC	1	3+	9	Destroyer 5+, Dev 2, Precision 2

The Typhon is less a creature and more a living fortress; the very ground trembles beneath its colossal tread. Clad in impenetrable, heavy-plated scales, it shrugs off all but the most concerted assaults. While the Typhon is typically observed acting as a defensive entity near Bioficer beacons, this passivity is an illusion maintained solely by the signals emitted from those structures. Without the influence of the beacons, the creature's true, devastating aggression is unleashed.



Type	Mv	A	DP	Special
Vehicle (Fauna)	6	5	4	Climber, Voracious, Instinct: Skulk

Name	Arc	MA	R	Att	Ac	E	Special
 Grasping Tentacles	F/S/R	Full	CC	1	3+	3	Suppress, Grapple
 Piercing Claws	F/S/R	Full	CC	2	4+	4	Destroyer 6+, Precision 2

The Keres is a nightmarish, tentacled behemoth that stalks the ruins of the Tlalocan Moons, scavenging the wounded and the recently fallen. Its elongated, clawed limbs allow it to maintain a low, hunched profile while navigating the cityscape, yet they are equally lethal in combat, capable of piercing vehicle plating to reach the soft targets within. Once prey is snared in its toxic, constricting tentacles, any hope of rescue is effectively extinguished.